

Good, Better, Best

The following table is a general rule of thumb regarding how FICO credit scores are judged by creditors:

Less than 619	High risk
620 – 660	Uncertain
661 – 720	Average (acceptable)
721 and higher	Very good
Over 750	Excellent

How We Rank

Recent credit scores among the U.S. population approximately rank out:

Up to 499: 1%
500 – 599: 12%
600 – 699: 27%
700 – 749: 20%
750 – 799: 29%
Over 800: 11%

40% of us fall in the “Over 750” ranking. Excellent. 13% of us fall under 600, which is very high risk. With a score of 600 to a score of 749, those 47% are the bread and butter of the industry.

Fair Credit Reporting Act

Until the Fair Credit Reporting Act came along, we, the consumers, had to pay for our credit reports. They, the credit reporting agencies, who keep tabs on our every move, made us pay to find out what they were saying about us. Ridiculous. This Act required that the credit reporting agencies supply us, me and you, the good people of America, with free copies of our credit reports, upon request, once every twelve months. However, the credit score is not technically part of the credit report, so they did not have to provide that for free. If you are supplied with a free score, verify that it is indeed the FICO score. Usually there is a fee for the FICO. You can always go to the website at www.myfico.com anytime to purchase your actual FICO score.